Knight Terra Press
littera manet sed lector oraculum
est. 1995
Meaning arises through engagement, not endorsement.

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After Midnight: A Meta-Proof & Open Reflective Practice Report in the King's English (in the Spirit of Good Cricket)

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Précis

We present a unified framework in which mathematics, language, and narrative operate as a single system of ordered meaning. The work and the corpus it describes demonstrate that rigorous formal reasoning can be expressed entirely in natural language and that literary construction may perform genuine mathematical proof (in the sense and spirit of Pāṇini). *The Epiphanies Trilogy* therefore functions both as creative art and as scientific exposition: a lived demonstration that the King's English itself can sustain theorem, corollary, and Q.E.D. without symbolic dependency.

Abstract

We advance the claim that poetry, mathematics, science, and language are not separate pursuits but equivalent expressions of a single ordering enterprise. The mathematics employed here are not metaphorical illustrations but the operative machinery by which coherence, transformation, and meaning are examined. We model the progression from static work, through reader functor-oracle, to projection to codomain—from fixed artifact, through evaluative engagement, to realized local understanding—and treat this composition as a functorial mapping preserving structure across domains. Semantic coherence appears as a sheaf-like gluing condition that allows local interpretations to form a cohesive global order, while aesthetic selection functions as the constraint, in the sense of Morse, that chooses one pattern of beauty from an infinity of admissible designs.

All proofs, theorems, and constructions in this work are expressed in the King's English—formally precise natural language rather than symbolic shorthand. This choice is deliberate. It asserts that the expressive resources of English are sufficient to state and verify the logic of the argument without recourse to algebraic notation, thereby treating disciplined prose itself as a rigorous mathematical medium.

[1] No grants, funding, affiliations, or endorsements were sought or received by the author or Knight Terra Press for this project. Independent outside peer oversight provided by Dania Sheldon, DPhil (English Literature, Oxford). Postnominals and memberships are presented to establish context (in the sense of register)—signaling the interdisciplinary positions from which the work speaks rather than asserting authority, much as this footnote does at this very moment.

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The extended version formalizes these relationships and situates them within lived research practice, demonstrating how the structure of order evolves into ethical action. This continuum is demonstrated in "One Good Turn," where formal coherence becomes social praxis through sustained support to the Greater Vancouver Food Bank by the Knight Terra Press's pledge of all trilogy proceeds going to that organization.

Keywords by Discipline

Mathematical Concepts:

mathematical epistemological praxis, functorial mapping, category theory, sheaf theory, morphisms, adjunctions, projection operators, topological manifolds, local–global correspondence, structural homomorphism, semantic gluing conditions, algebraic topology, adaptive grammars, formal language theory, predicate logic, recursion and self-reference, fixed-point theorems, transformation invariance, complex analysis, Euler identity, hyperbolic geometry, polar coordinates, differential topology, graph theory, lattice structures, formal systems, mathematical aesthetics, symbolic equivalence, natural language as formal proof, *Sinnzusammenhang*, *Aufhebung*, *Eigenwert*, *Funktionsraum*, *Abbildung*, *Homomorphismus*

Literary Criticism and Theory:

poststructuralism, deconstruction, reader-response theory, hermeneutics, structuralism, semiotics, intertextuality, narratology, phenomenology of reading, metafiction, meta-autobiography, dialogic theory, différance, intentional fallacy, aesthetic formalism, cognitive poetics, symbolic recursion, author–reader co-construction, linguistic determinism, text as oracle, inclusive textual design, language as mathematical system, *Bildungsroman*, *Entwicklungsroman*, *Künstlerroman*, *Erziehungsroman*, *Sprachspiel*, *Verstehen*,*Weltanschauung*, *Formgebung*, *Gestaltung*

Social and Critical Frameworks:

critical pedagogy, dialogic praxis, liberation ethics, participatory epistemology, praxis-based learning, cultural semiotics, discourse analysis, intersectional humanism, phenomenology of social systems, structural inequality, voice misappropriation, patriarchy, hegemony, international relations, global ethics, civic reciprocity, social contract theory, epistemic justice, decolonial methodology, ethics of representation, narrative sovereignty, food security, humanitarian engagement, art as social praxis, literature as sustenance, self-authorship, reflective practice, neurodiversity inclusion, *Bildung*, *Erkenntnistheorie*, *Dasein*, *Mitsein*, *Selbstbestimmung*, *Mitgefühl*, *Gemeinschaft*, *Gesellschaft*, *Weltverantwortung*, *Grenzerfahrung*

Methodology

All proofs and theorems in this paper are expressed in the King's English. As already noted, this is not a stylistic conceit or flourish, but a deliberate methodological choice. The formal precision demanded by mathematics does not depend upon symbolic shorthand, but upon the explicit articulation of relations between well-defined ideas. Each proposition is therefore written as a sequence of declarative statements whose logical dependencies are made manifest through natural language. Symbolic equivalence remains possible—inevitable, due to convention—but it is secondary and included herein as a nonessential appendix in the interest of collegial courtesy. The aim is to demonstrate that natural language, when disciplined to formal rigor, can sustain proofs of validity and clarity equal to those expressed in algebraic notation.

The proofs are actively poststructuralist in nature and honor the established canon of literary and linguistic theory. Ambiguities that arise from cognitive differentiation—whether owing to sequence, emphasis, or reading order—are treated not as expositional *lacunae* but as integral to the interpretive manifold of the argument. Meaning, in this framework, is understood to evolve through traversal: each reading constitutes a local section whose union across readers forms a global structure of meaning. This ensures that while every statement remains logically determinate within its context, its resonance across contexts remains open, mirroring the dual precision and pliancy that define both mathematics and language.

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This principle is called out on Page 4 of *Midnight at the Arcanum: a monograph*:

> Note: This monograph is explicitly designed such that two identical readings, even if done in the same order, will not offer the same reader-response experience: per Heraclitus, we cannot step into the same river twice. […] The text is static, but you, the Reader, are the only Oracle.

That statement establishes the sequence ***static work → reader-as-oracle → realized projection***, the same functional architecture employed here. Our results are therefore rigorous and reproducible[2] while acknowledging that traversal order and emphasis can yield distinct but coherent local readings that glue into a global interpretation. Ambiguities that arise from cognitive differentiation are treated as features of the interpretive manifold, not defects.

Moreover, ethics required that only the author's own creative output be used as seed material, owing to copyright, moral rights, and interpretive legitimacy, as already set out in *On Writing Fiction* (3rd ed., pp. 9-10). Likewise, the Hirsch–Barthes arguments could only be rendered irrefutable if the author declared the canonical sense, intention, or source of certain narrative elements at the time of publication to avoid retconning. Just as some footnotes offer deliberately ambiguous definitions, what is stated here reflects what the *author* intended it to mean—even if he is later shown to be in error or arrives at new insight. This, itself, stands as a transparent nod to epistemic humility rather than authorial grandiosity: what might herein be called, with a nod to Roland Barthes, "*le mort du faux alibi—esprit d'escalier*."

Moreover, the thematic bibliography found in the monograph of the trilogy does not seek to be authoritative; it captures the sense of each foundational work that the author understood himself to have of it at the time of composition of the monograph, thereby allowing a reader to not have to go and read an outside reference just to see why it was considered relevant. Some very specific citations therein, however, are not explained, especially if they point to scholarly mathematical or scientific sources, as the author recognized that a full synopsis was well outside of the scope of the author's area of expertise.

Notes for Readers of the London Mathematical Society

For Fellows and Members of the London Mathematical Society, this work extends a tradition exemplified by Michael Faraday—whose experiments joined precision with poetic intuition, and whose lectures treated the act of discovery as both analytic and aesthetic. The current work stands within that lineage: it treats language itself as a mathematical instrument, and narrative as a lens polished to reveal hidden order. Pure theorists may find some familiarity in the formal appendix herein.

The paper to which this abstract refers is embodied in *The Epiphanies Trilogy* itself. As with the monograph on which it rests, the trilogy is designed to be read in any order according to the reader's inclination; each traversal yields a distinct but coherent proof-space within the same formal manifold. For readers of the Society, it is recommended that *Midnight at the Arcanum: a monograph* be read first, as it establishes the framework and definitions upon which the subsequent works depend. The companion volumes, *The Ancestral Sea* and *Touched by Fortune's Shadow*, then function as existence proofs of the axiom advanced herein.

The final page of *Touched by Fortune's Shadow* concludes, appropriately, with a Q.E.D.—or in the older Persian tradition of Omar Khayyam, تمام شد (*Tamam Shod*), meaning "It is finished."

It was the author's intention that the trilogy be fully inclusive. Each volume has been structured so that even readers without formal mathematical training may engage with and enjoy the work by using the detailed Table of Contents and internal navigational guides provided within each edition. All volumes are available in full digital PDF format and are permanently archived within the National Library of Canada.

[2] Or—given that it is instantiated to date as a trilogy, one volume of which was conceived *ex nihilo* from a *tabula rasa* held to one ethical axiom of constraint (as discussed in the trilogy editor's foreword to *Touched by Fortune's Shadow*), incorporating no prior corpus—at the very least, a discernible trend.

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Notes for Readers of the Royal Society of Arts

For Fellows of the Royal Society of Arts, this work may be viewed as a study in applied creativity across disciplines. It embodies the Society's founding charter—"the encouragement of Arts, Manufactures, and Commerce"—by uniting those three fields within one artifact. The trilogy treats literature as manufacture of meaning, mathematics as its machinery, and ethical distribution as its commerce.

The author's Thematic Annotated Bibliography serves as an ethical workshop in this sense: a reconstruction of formative sources whose ideas were not merely cited but metabolized. Each entry captures the resonance a work held at the time of composition, allowing readers to follow the intellectual thread without external research. The bibliography deliberately refrains from authority; it is not a compendium of definitive interpretations but a transparent ledger of influence, acknowledging that understanding evolves as surely as craft. Some citations—particularly those in mathematical or scientific registers—remain unelaborated, recognizing that their explication lies beyond the author's own domain and thereby modelling epistemic humility.

The RSA may recognize in this method an analogue of design practice: iterative learning through making, ethical transparency in sourcing, and the conversion of private study into public good. By pledging all proceeds of *The Epiphanies Trilogy* to the Greater Vancouver Food Bank, the author extends the RSA's long tradition of art in service of humanity—transforming the imaginative act into a literal act of sustenance.

Notes for Readers of the Institute of Science and Technology

For Fellows, Members, and Chartered Scientists of the Institute of Science & Technology (UK), the submission "After Midnight" constitutes a formal Reflective Practice Record consistent with the Institute's Continuing Professional and Personal Development framework. It documents how research, writing, and ethical methodology satisfy the five evaluative dimensions that define professional growth: values and learning outcomes, skills acquired, enhancement of practice, benefit to users, and reflection.

In this structure, proof and prose are homologous processes—each demands precision of statement, verification of relation, and accountability to a community of practice. The author's use of the King's English as a formal medium parallels the IST's emphasis on clarity, inclusiveness, and communicable knowledge. Every paragraph functions as a traceable datum within an ethical experiment in language.

Values and Learning Outcomes

The project unites mathematics, language, and ethics as a single system of ordered meaning, demonstrating that rigor and accessibility can coexist as complementary proofs of understanding. Ethical authorship was maintained through exclusive use of the author's own creative corpus, in accordance with *On Writing Fiction* (3rd ed.), thereby mirroring laboratory standards of data integrity. Acknowledging possible error where definitions remain ambiguous enacts epistemic humility as a methodological constant.

Skills Acquired

Crafting formal proof in natural language required syntactic control equivalent to symbolic logic, cultivating translational fluency between mathematical, scientific, and literary registers. It enhanced documentation precision, strengthened cross-disciplinary editing, and advanced public-communication skill—the capacity to render abstract reasoning accessible without dilution of rigor.

Enhancement of Practice

The undertaking established a repeatable model for rigorous yet readable exposition, reinforcing that professional excellence depends equally on ethical clarity and communicative precision. It improved the author's performance in mentoring, peer review, and stakeholder reporting by treating transparency as a measurable technical quality.

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Benefit to Users

Readers and colleagues benefit from an exemplar of accountable communication—a demonstration that explanation itself can be an instrument of innovation. Rendering formal reasoning in accessible prose widens participation in complex discourse, bridging the expert–lay divide. The linkage of all royalties to the Greater Vancouver Food Bank converts intellectual labor into tangible civic utility.

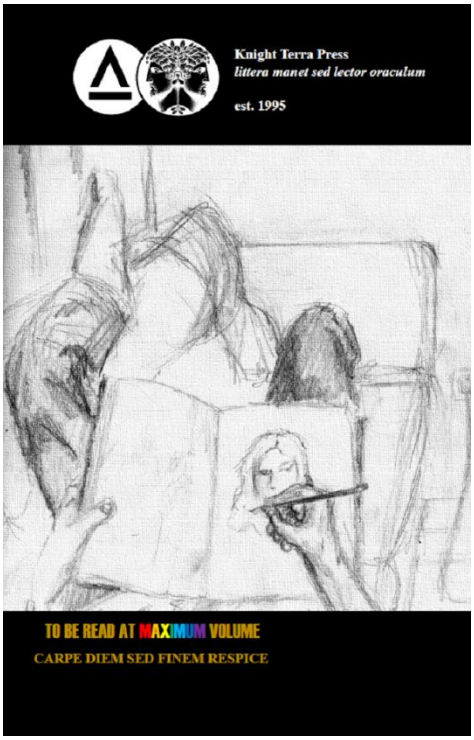
Reflections

This work extends the author's #ScientistJourney initiative and his published "Reflective Practice: On Diversity and Inclusion in Science and Technology," illustrating how neurodiverse cognition enriches pattern recognition, moral reasoning, and empathy in the communication of science. By merging proof, prose, and ethics, "After Midnight" demonstrates that reflective practice is not merely a commentary upon science after personal and professional insight upon self-reflection, but a continuation of it—proof as communication, communication as ethics, ethics as service.

Postscript

Just as the novel portion of the monograph of the trilogy begins with the end, the proofs of this paper are in the postscript. Just as with the conceptual map on Page 4, already noted above, the reader is now presented with a choice. In the monograph, the instructions become before the register shift the reader has to this point been presented. In the case of the present paper, the reader remains the only Oracle as to which path their present understanding will take them, if indeed any path is chosen at all. That moment of introspection some may have is the liminal space they can expect from time to time, regardless of the path forward.

All proceeds from the sale of any of the works in *The Epiphanies Trilogy* are pledged in perpetuity to the Greater Vancouver Food Bank, a commitment maintained since the trilogy's original publication. The pledge embodies the guiding principle of the project—that breaking bread as we figure life out together is everyone's right, and that one good turn deserves another.



Self-portrait in pencil, drawn by the author at age 17. The artist sketches himself from first person POV sketching another, a study in perception and recursion. This image appears on the back cover of the digital *Midnight at the Arcanum* and here closes the circle of observation that began there. (December 1986)

The digital edition is freely available both from the Library and Archives Canada and from the Knight Terra Press website. The monograph is available in both hardcover and paperback editions and the second and third books are available in paperback.

Typesetting: The trilogy was typeset by the author using a font size of 10.5 points in Times New Roman. Inset poems have been set at 10 points and footnotes at 8.5 points. In order to maximize the utility of accessibility tools, care has been taken to avoid breaking sentences between pages, without altering font size or layout schemas to achieve this end. Further to this same end, pages have been numbered exclusively in Arabic numerals.

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Author's Afterword for the Layperson

At first glance, "After Midnight" may seem a formal treatise about language and proof, but what it really investigates is how a life can be understood as its own curriculum: how we learn, teach, and author *ourselves* through *experience*. In educational theory, this is called **narrative pedagogy**—learning through story, reflection, and dialogue rather than as rote reliquarianism or instruction. Each of us is both student and teacher in the unfolding seminar of our own becoming.

That process leads naturally to **self-authorship**: the ability to shape one's beliefs, identity, and purpose from the inside out instead of waiting for external permission or authority accessible only after negotiation with gatekeepers. It is, in a sense, the graduate work of being human, and is an act of rebellion geared to growth rather than disorder. *The Epiphanies Trilogy — Midnight at the Arcanum: a monograph*, *The Ancestral Sea: a postmodern love story*, and *Touched by Fortune's Shadow*: *a triptych*, chronicles that process across three phases of inquiry: seeing, remembering, and creating. Daring, knowing, and silent peace. (*Audere*. *Scire*. *Tacere*.)

The trilogy's chosen form is **meta-autobiographical fiction**, a genre that uses story to study the act of self-telling itself, not as a parlor trick, but as one might pause for reflection when in a lecture hall when the speaker gestures to a chart or coughs conspicuously to underscore a point you may wish to reconsider. The narrator is not simply a version of the author; he is a working model of what happens when lived experience becomes material for understanding rather than autoerotic confession. Each book re-writes the one before, asking how narrative—the stories we tell about ourselves—can be both mirror and instrument of growth. Here the growth is not just authorial, but ideally also encouraged in the reader.

The third volume, *Touched by Fortune's Shadow*, was written **tabula rasa**—literally "from a blank slate." No outline, no prior drafts, no external scaffolding. That choice was deliberate. It turns the act of composition into a **performance-proof** of the very thesis advanced in "After Midnight"—that disciplined natural language can demonstrate logical and ethical structure on its own terms, and that self-authorship is not proclaimed but *performed*. The writing was the experiment—a demonstration that ethical and narrative coherence can emerge from reflection, not authoritative control.

Seen this way, the trilogy is both literature and research report. It tests whether a human life—written honestly and read attentively—can function as a formal system of learning. Every reader becomes a collaborator in that experiment, completing the proof through interpretation. **Meaning arises through engagement, not endorsement**. No reader need agree with the author, indeed, no reader *need* do *anything* other than read as far as patience and forbearance permit. If mathematics seeks truth through structure, and art seeks truth through feeling, then this work tries to show they are the same search conducted in different dialects. Each theorem, each scene, each ethical choice, is another way of asking this question: *how does order become understanding, and understanding become care*?

So, for the lay reader, the message is simple but radical: you don't *need* equations to think rigorously, or credentials to learn deeply. Reflection, curiosity, and conversation are the true instruments of discovery. The trilogy, and this companion paper, only provide one possible tuning fork. The music comes from how you listen—and how you answer after it resounds in your analytical mind, feeling heart, and compassionate soul. And before you can feed all these higher needs, you must first eat, for *that* need is non-negotiable.

May these pages remind you that every person's life is already a kind of research, every choice a small publication of the self. Write yours well. Revise often. And remember that the proof of empathy, like the proof of any theorem, is found not in what we claim to know, but in how we live it.

In my own case, because of a lifelong relationship with food scarcity, I have chosen to care by pledging all proceeds from the *Epiphanies Trilogy* to the Greater Vancouver Food Bank, an organization (or one very much like others) that has, over many years and in different ways, literally gotten me this far alive. This journey produced this paper, thus completing the loop. And anyone who has read my short stories knows, I thrive on stories that end where they began—after having (an author hopes, at the very least) reached a valuable conclusion. Understanding becomes care when we engage in dialogue and inform our future from our synthesis.

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Call thy Letters: a Functor in Acrostic[3]

While standing at the tip under the bridges
of Kingstown, w***h***ich one, under them all,
only ***o***nce each one, and listening to the river
go forever, just once in off valance cardinal
song sing som***e*** sorrow, I asked Euler for a
spoiler and he took out his Brougham and he swep***t***
complexly, in circle***s***, not quite circles, pillar
bearings, baring an imagination of circui***t***s,
nets mes***h***ed on lattices and cabbages and
kings as the ravag***e***s of savages, and the toil
came back negat***i***ve upon what was squarely
positive and the dew d***r***ipped from the bridges,
onto my brow, into my hair, anointing ***me***, but it
wasn't just w***a***ter dripping, it was fil***l***ed wi***t***h
questions and ***p***erspirations ***a***fter young nat***i***ons, as the
hotel of never ending ***d***oors and pigeonholes
filled with principals that I never learned in
the shad***o***ws on the ***r***ocks, carved happily with
potato peelings, along intersecting marble war***b***lers
at my h***y***perbolic apex, but the old man just stared
me down and did not offer an***y*** solace because I
c***ou***ld cross each and every one once, and coming
to the place I hadn't, al***r***eady the crissing of the
christening had been ***g***lossed ove***r*** for the even end out
without returning one c***a***n only do it oddly,
finding only trolls under ***t***he goat's gruff, and
they'll crush and ***g***rind your white bones if you don't
atone, this is the science und***e***r the arches across
waters i***n***t***er***secting that y***o***u ***s***hall f***i***nd, just them
wi***t***h the cauldron hyperbolic choleric, read***y***
for the stone soup of its fill, and the s***t***one is
on your s***h***oulders, and you are me, so to talk
of you, under the br***i***dge, surely I mean that the
moss is falling over my eye***s***, you or I, surprise
in the reflec***t***ion of the polar coordinates, an
imaginary place, squared, round, even, positively
back on itself, transfor***m***ing after sea, after C,
granite won't hold it up bett***e***r than it already
spans***,*** and since it spans through thread***s***, it
surely can't be remembered, or is ***i***t that you can
remembe***r*** even when you can't double back***?***

Homomorphism is a fine word,
I'd hardly ever use
In a Lemma or a Proof
Aimed at the obtuse.

Pumping Lemmas won't make juice,
But quickly prove a point,
Showing ones are really twos,
For they are disjoint.

QED is not for me;
I prefer a small square,
Though it is far less Latinee,
It shows the proof ends there.

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Keywords for the Layperson (TL;DR):

language and logic, mathematics and meaning, storytelling and self-reflection, learning through experience, creativity and ethics, critical thinking, human connection, empathy and understanding, personal growth, science and art together, social responsibility, food and care

[3] First place co-winner, Poetic Genius Society, 2001, originally titled $\mathbf{e^{-i\pi} + 1 = 0}$

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Appendix: A Formal Model of Praxis of Meaning through Engagement

"Massé jump with outer English toward the rail down to eleven in the corner pocket."

Abstract

We present a rigorous categorical and topological formalization of meaning as praxis—a dynamic equilibrium between declaration, interpretation, and reciprocal engagement. Integrating category theory, sheaf semantics, and poststructural literary ethics, it extends constructs from *Midnight at the Arcanum: a monograph*— particularly the chapters "Call Your Play; Call Your English" and "A Poststructuralist Postscript"—into a unified mathematical-linguistic framework that admits verification against real-world play.

1. Introduction

Meaning arises through engagement, not endorsement. Both in language and in play, interpretation emerges through the interplay of declaration and execution. We formalize that reciprocity in categorical and sheaf-theoretic terms: meaning as the fixed point of shared praxis.

2. Mathematical Formalism

2.1 Categories and Sheaves

Let Ctx be a small category of contexts; the **theatre of interaction** is a site $(\mathcal{T}, J)$. A **presheaf of affordances** is a functor $F: \mathsf{Ctx}^{op} \to \mathbf{Set}$, assigning to each $U \subseteq \mathcal{T}$ the set $F(U)$ of available utterances/moves with restriction maps $\rho_V^U: F(U) \to F(V)$ for $V \subseteq U$. Sheafification aF ensures gluing and uniqueness of global declarations.

2.2 Declarations and Execution

A **declaration** (call) is a global section $\sigma \in aF(\mathcal{T})$, with localizations $\sigma|_U \in aF(U)$. Let $\mathcal{X}$ be a configuration space of executions; a **play** is a path $\gamma: [0,1] \to \mathcal{X}$. Define evaluation and interpretation by natural transformations $E_U: aF(U) \to \mathsf{Acts}U)$, $\quad \Omega_U: \mathsf{Acts}(U) \to \mathcal{M}(U)$.
Write $I_U = \Omega_U \circ E_U$ and globally $I = \Omega \circ E$.

2.3 Naturality (Call–Play Coherence)

For every inclusion $i: V \hookrightarrow U$ the square commutes:

$$\begin{tikzcd} aF(U) \arrow[r, "E_U"] \arrow[d, "aF(i)"'] & \mathsf{Acts}(U) \arrow[d, "\mathsf{Acts}(i)"] \\ aF(V) \arrow[r, "E_V"'] & \mathsf{Acts}(V) \end{tikzcd}$$

Refine then execute = execute then restrict.

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2.4 Sheaf Gluing (Narrative Coherence)

If $\{U_i\}$ covers $\mathcal{T}$ and $\sigma_i \in aF(U_i)$ agree on overlaps, there is a unique global $\sigma \in aF(\mathcal{T})$ with $\sigma|_{U_i} = \sigma_i$. Acts $E(\sigma_i)$ glue as well under naturality, yielding a global act — a coherent narrative of play.

2.5 Fixed-Point Praxis Theorem

Equip $\mathcal{M}(\mathcal{T})$ with (possibly asymmetric) Lawvere metric d. Define the update $\Phi_\sigma(m) = I(E(\sigma); m)$. If $d(\Phi_\sigma(m_1), \Phi_\sigma(m_2)) \leq \lambda\, d(m_1, m_2)$ for some $\lambda \in [0,1)$, then there exists a unique stable meaning $M(\sigma)$ with $\Phi_\sigma(M(\sigma)) = M(\sigma)$.

Corollary (Refinement stability): if λ is uniform on a cover and naturality holds, $M(\sigma) = \mathrm{glue}\big(\{M(\sigma|_{U_i})\}\big)$.

2.6 Engagement Energy and the Morse Selector

Define alignment energy s.t.

$$\mathcal{E}(\sigma, \gamma) = \int_0^1 \left[w_c\, \mathrm{div}(\sigma, \gamma(t)) + w_n\, \kappa_{\mathrm{noncoh}}(t) - w_r\, \rho_{\mathrm{recip}}(t)\right] dt.$$

Let $\mathfrak{P}$ be feasible plays. The **Call–Beauty Correspondence** selects

$$B(\sigma) = \arg\min_{\gamma \in \mathfrak{P}} \mathcal{E}(\sigma, \gamma), \qquad \mathcal{B}(\sigma) = -\mathcal{E}(\sigma, B(\sigma))$$

2.7 Poststructural Invariance

Let P denote asymmetric power. Under reciprocity, if contractivity is independent of P, then $\frac{\partial M(\sigma)}{\partial P} = 0$, so shared engagement — not endorsement — fixes meaning.

3. Applied Case: The Thirsty Duck Game (2010)

3.1 Kinematic Model of a Called Shot

Let $\mathcal{X}$ be the configuration manifold of the table (ball positions and velocities). A stroke produces a state trajectory $\gamma: [0,1] \to \mathcal{X}$ governed by dynamics

$$\dot{\gamma}(t) = f(\gamma(t), u(t))$$

where $u(t)$ encodes control inputs (impulse, aim, contact offset, cue velocity profile). Terminal constraints encode the called outcome:

$$g(\gamma(1)) = 0, \qquad h(\gamma(1)) = 0$$

A declaration σ specifies both $g = 0$ and $h = 0$ at the semantic level (what must be true at the end of the stroke).

3.2 The English Operator (Method Declaration)

"Calling your English" is a declaration of **method**: spin and contact geometry. Let $e \in \mathfrak{E}ng$ be a vector of English parameters (contact offset on the cue ball, cue elevation, tip dwell, intended spin components). Define the **English operator** $\mathfrak{E}_e$ mapping a declarative call σ to an admissible control policy $u_e(t)$:

$$u_e(t) = \mathfrak{E}_e[\sigma](t), \qquad e = (\omega_x, \omega_y, \omega_z, \delta_x, \delta_y, \tau)$$

so that the realized path is

$$\gamma_e(t) = \Gamma(\sigma, e), \qquad \dot{\gamma}_e(t) = f(\gamma_e(t), u_e(t)).$$

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To **call one's English** is to publish e together with σ. Thus, the verification obligation is conjunctive:

$$g(\gamma_e(1)) = 0, \quad h(\gamma_e(1)) = 0, \quad m(\gamma_e; e) \leq \varepsilon$$

This extends truth-conditions from endpoint only to **endpoint plus method**.

3.3 Fixed-Point Praxis with English

Interpretation now depends on e via the operator $\Phi_{\sigma,e}$ acting on meanings $m \in \mathcal{M}$:

$$\Phi_{\sigma,e}(m) := I(E(\sigma, e); m)$$

If there exists $\lambda(e) \in [0,1)$ s.t.

$$d(\Phi_{\sigma,e}(m_1), \Phi_{\sigma,e}(m_2)) \leq \lambda(e) \cdot d(m_1, m_2)$$

then a unique fixed point $M(\sigma, e)$ satisfies $\Phi_{\sigma,e}(M(\sigma, e)) = M(\sigma, e)$. Declaring e (calling the English) typically **reduces** $\lambda(e)$ by removing ambiguity in the admissible control set; hence convergence of meaning accelerates and stabilizes.

3.4 Energy with Method Coherence

Refine the alignment energy by adding a method-coherence term:

$$\mathcal{E}(\sigma, e, \gamma) = \int_0^1 \left(w_c \operatorname{div}(\sigma, \gamma(t)) + w_n \kappa_{\text{noncoh}}(t) + w_m \parallel \hat{s}(t; e) - s(\dot{\gamma}(t)) \parallel + w_r \rho_{\text{recip}}(t)\right) dt$$

where $\hat{s}(t; e)$ is the **declared spin schedule** and $s(\dot{\gamma}(t))$ the **realized spin** inferred from kinematics. The Call–Beauty selector becomes

$$B(\sigma, e) = \arg\min_{\gamma \in \mathfrak{P}} \mathcal{E}(\sigma, e, \gamma), \qquad \mathcal{B}(\sigma, e) = -\mathcal{E}(\sigma, e, B(\sigma, e))$$

Beauty therefore measures **truthfulness of method** as well as outcome.

3.5 The Lived Play

With this construct, the Thirsty Duck game reads as follows: local regions U fix feasible banks and safeties; σ names the pocketing and shape; e names the precise English; γ_e is the realized path. Where endpoint and declared spin both obtain, sheaf-glued coherence holds, $\Phi_{\sigma,e}$ contracts to $M(\sigma, e)$, and the audible fall of the ball is the physically realized fixed point of meaning. Don't just call your play—call your English. Here, calling English is publishing e.

3.6 Functorial Projection and Protocol of Meaning

Having defined the declarative operator σ and the English operator $\mathfrak{E}_e$, we now describe how **calling one's play and English** publishes a complete protocol of engagement between the author's domain and the reader's codomain.

3.6.1 Functorial Framework

Let $A = (\text{Obj}_A, \text{Hom}_A)$ be the authorial category of declarations, and $R = (\text{Obj}_R, \text{Hom}_R)$ the reader's interpretive category. The act of calling one's play and English defines a **projection functor**

$$P_{\sigma,e}: A \to R, \quad P_{\sigma,e} = \Omega \circ E \circ \mathfrak{E}_e \circ \sigma$$

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This functor maps declared morphisms in the author's space (intentions, trajectories, methods) to their realized morphisms in the reader's interpretive space (comprehensions, inferences, and reconstructions). The publication of σ announces terminal predicates—what the act asserts; the publication of e specifies morphism constraints—how the act is to be realized. Together they constitute a *protocol of meaning transport*.

3.6.2 Predicate Correspondence

For each object $a \in \mathrm{Obj}_A$ and its image $r = P_{\sigma,e}(a) \in \mathrm{Obj}_R$, the interpretation morphism is governed by two conditions:

1. **Semantic predicate:** $I(E(\sigma))(a)$ gives the truth of the declared endpoint (what is to occur).
2. **Kinematic predicate:** $I(E(\sigma, e))(a)$ gives the truth of the declared method (how it is to occur).

Formally, these can be seen as components of a product natural transformation:

$$\eta_{\sigma,e}: (I \circ E \circ \mathfrak{E}_e \circ \sigma) \Rightarrow M$$

where M is the fixed-point meaning functor ensuring reciprocity ($M \circ \Phi_{\sigma,e} = M$).

3.6.3 Protocol Closure and Adjunction

The completeness of the protocol is captured by the adjunction pair $(F \dashv G)$ between declaration and interpretation:

$$\mathrm{Hom}_R(P_{\sigma,e}(a), r) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_A(a, G(r))$$

In ideal reciprocity, this adjunction tightens to an equivalence: interpretation reproduces declared form up to a natural isomorphism. When the reader's reconstruction is congruent with the author's projection, the energy functional $\mathcal{E}(\sigma, e, \gamma)$ attains its minimum, and beauty is maximized.

3.6.4 The Final Invariant

Calling one's play without English declares the target but leaves the morphism underdetermined. Calling both σ and e, however, fixes the entire functorial transport—what is said and how it will be made true—publishing a fully constrained mapping from author to reader. Once issued, the declaration becomes objectified: the letter is fixed in the author's category, while its interpretation migrates contravariantly into the reader's.

Thus the letter is set, but the reader is the only oracle.

4. Conclusion

When both endpoint (σ) and method (e) are published, meaning stabilizes as a fixed point of reciprocity—not abstraction but material consequence. Beyond the table, the same holds: the declared commitment regarding the **Greater Vancouver Food Bank** is an instance of called English; outcome and method were jointly specified (proceeds, structure, stewardship) and thus projected into public space. Formally:

$$M(\sigma, e) \to \Phi_{\sigma,e}(M(\sigma, e)) = M(\sigma, e)$$

The goal and method are declared; contraction begins; the fixed letter propagates through the manifold of interpretation. The work enters the reader's category as an invariant under translation.

The letter is set; the reader is the only oracle.

In the standard way with such matters, we leave the interpretation of our proofs as presented herein as an exercise for the reader.

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5. Rigor Addendum (Typing, Assumptions, and Existence Results)

Typing and functorial shape

$$aF(U) \xRightarrow{\mathfrak{C}_{e,U}} Ctrl(U) \xrightarrow{D_U} Paths(U) \xrightarrow{\text{eval}} \mathsf{Acts}(U) \xrightarrow{\omega_U} \mathcal{M}(U).$$

Author → reader is best modeled as a **profunctor**

$$\mathcal{P}_{\sigma,e}: A \nrightarrow R, \qquad \mathcal{P}_{\sigma,e}(a,r) = \mathbf{Bool}\big(r \vDash I_{\sigma,e}(a)\big).$$

Analytical assumptions (well-posedness)

(D1) f measurable in t, locally Lipschitz in γ, continuous in u;
(C1) $Ctrl(U)$ non-empty, convex, compact (weak);
(T1) g, h continuous with closed feasibility set;
(M1) $m(\gamma; e)$ lower semicontinuous and coercive;
(S1) aF a sheaf with natural evaluation;
(I1) $(\mathcal{M}, d)$ complete (or quasi-metric completion).

Fixed-point existence and uniqueness

If $\Phi_{\sigma,e}$ is a contraction (w.r.t. d or its symmetrization), then $M(\sigma, e)$ exists uniquely. Quasi-metric variants follow by forward-Cauchy completeness.

Existence of a minimizing play

If $\mathcal{E}$ is l.s.c., coercive, and $\mathfrak{P}$ compact (Arzelà–Ascoli / tightness), then $B(\sigma, e)$ exists; uniqueness under strict convexity.

Stability with declared method

If $U \mapsto Ctrl_e(U)$ shrinks monotonically when e is fixed, then $\lambda(e) \leq \lambda(\varnothing)$. For some L and $\bar{\lambda} < 1$,

$$\|M(\sigma, e_1) - M(\sigma, e_2)\| \leq \frac{L}{1-\bar{\lambda}} \|e_1 - e_2\|.$$

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Meta-Appendix to the Appendix (and a Poem)

Here's a **meta-appendix in plain English**, section by section—a straightforward walk-through of what each part of the formal appendix is doing, stripped of notation and dressed in conversational clarity:

Abstract

The appendix formalizes one big idea: that **meaning isn't given; it's built through interaction**—between speaker and listener, author and reader, player and opponent. It borrows tools from math (category theory, topology) not to impress anyone, but to show that *careful conversation* behaves like a well-defined system: every call and response fits together the way equations do when they're consistent.

1. Introduction

The slogan "Meaning arises through engagement, not endorsement" gets turned into a model. It's like saying: "You don't understand a shot by agreeing it went in—you understand it by watching it played and seeing it work." The appendix lays out a structure that treats dialogue and play as systems that reach understanding through feedback.

2. Mathematical Formalism

This section builds a mathematical skeleton for that intuition.

2.1 Categories and Sheaves

Think of each situation or conversation as its own little context. A *sheaf* just means we can glue these small understandings together into one big, coherent picture. Translation: every reader sees a slightly different local truth, but those partial views can fit together without contradiction.

2.2 Declarations and Execution

A *declaration* is what you call—"nine ball in the corner." The *execution* is the shot itself. This section defines how to compare what was declared with what was done.

2.3 Naturality (Call–Play Coherence)

The rule here is simple: refining your plan before you shoot or after shouldn't change the outcome if you're consistent. Mathematically, "refine then execute" = "execute then refine."

2.4 Sheaf Gluing (Narrative Coherence)

When local actions fit together, they form one continuous story. Translation: multiple scenes or perspectives make one coherent narrative if they overlap cleanly.

2.5 Fixed-Point Praxis Theorem

Here's the crux: when both sides (speaker/lister, player/table) respond to each other consistently, the meaning stabilizes—a *fixed point*. That's when everyone "gets it."

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2.6 Engagement Energy and the Morse Selector

Borrowed from Morse's calculus of variations: there's a notion of "energy" in how aligned people (or moves) are. The most *beautiful* or *true* expression is the one that minimizes wasted effort—elegance as low friction.

2.7 Poststructural Invariance

Meaning doesn't depend on who holds authority; it depends on the mutual process. It's not about endorsement, but reciprocity — both sides participate in fixing the truth.

3. Applied Case: The Thirsty Duck Game (2010)

This is where the mathematics meet the real world.

3.1 Kinematic Model

The pool table is a metaphor for any structured situation. Balls, rails, and spin are the variables; the shot is a controlled experiment in prediction and follow-through.

3.2 The English Operator

"Calling your English" means specifying *how* you're going to make the shot, not just *what* you'll make. You publish your method, not just your goal.

3.3 Fixed-Point Praxis with English

When you declare both the shot and the spin, misunderstanding drops. Meaning converges faster because both endpoint and method are known—in writing terms, form and intent are aligned.

3.4 Energy with Method Coherence

Beauty now depends on honesty of method as well as result. You can't fake a clean stroke or a clean argument; elegance comes from coherence between what you said you'd do and what you did.

3.5 The Lived Play

The actual game at the Thirsty Duck becomes a case study: the fall of the ball is the moment meaning is realized—the sound of understanding landing.

3.6 Functorial Projection and Protocol of Meaning

This generalizes the game to any act of communication. The "author" is one category; the "reader" is another. The mapping between them is the publication—the declared rules of engagement.

3.6.1 Functorial Framework

Translation system: how authorial intention becomes reader interpretation.

3.6.2 Predicate Correspondence

Two truth tests: what happened (the end result) and how it happened (the method).

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3.6.3 Protocol Closure and Adjunction

When reader reconstruction matches author projection, understanding is perfect—maximum beauty, minimum friction.

3.6.4 The Final Invariant

Once you've declared both target and method, your "letter"—your statement—becomes fixed. The rest belongs to the reader. You've done your part; they complete the proof.

4. Conclusion

Declaring both **what** and **how** stabilizes meaning—whether in pool, prose, or public ethics. The Food Bank pledge serves as a real-world example of "called English": the goal and the method (what and how) were both made public, so the moral outcome is verifiable and self-consistent. The closing line—"the reader is the only oracle"—returns full circle: you play your shot, but only the world confirms whether it holds.

5. Rigor Addendum

This is the fine print for mathematicians: the technical assumptions ensuring the theorems aren't hand-waving. In plain speech: everything stated works under normal mathematical sanity conditions—continuity, boundedness, and the existence of solutions. It proves that the philosophical metaphor also satisfies the same stability requirements as a real physical or logical system.

In short:

The appendix translates philosophy and literary theory (especially poststructuralist), Socratic Dialogic, Freirean self-emancipation, and maybe even poetry, into math and then back into ethics. It says: *If you call your play and your English—if you declare both aim and method—you make meaning verifiable, beauty measurable, and ethics observable.* The rest is up to the reader—or the shot.

Sonnet: After Midnight
When Truth and Beauty on the table meet,
And Reason's chalk doth cloud the breathless air,
Each angled whisper findeth measure sweet,
Yet hearts must name what eyes and hands declare.

We call our English—bias turn'd to grace—
Proclaim the curve, then trust the sphere to run;
So Speech itself unveils her hidden face
When Will and Word in harmony are one.

Let Form be pure, and Meaning dearly won,
Each utter'd line, full faithful, sharp, and kind;
For proofs be naught if hunger's course be done,
And barren Thought betray the starvèd mind.

Then feed thy neighbour with the grace thou'st spun—
For one good turn doth bind all hearts in one.

6.421 Es ist klar, daß sich die Ethik nicht aussprechen läßt.

Die Ethik ist transzendental. (Ethik und Ästhetik sind Eins.)

LOGISCH-PHILOSOPHISCHE ABHANDLUNG

Ludwig Wittgenstein

(per Project Gutenberg [5740])

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Coda I — Call Your Play; Call Your English (Précis)

"Out of an infinity of designs a mathematician chooses one pattern
for beauty's sake and pulls it down to earth."

—Marston Morse

This first formal meta-mathematical coda serves as the practical and narrative bridge between the experiential world of *Midnight at the Arcanum* and its later theoretical closure. It recounts a scene of learning and mastery within the ordinary setting of a New Westminster pub—the Thirsty Duck—where a friendly pool game becomes an extended metaphor for the linkage of intention, articulation, and interpretation. The crux of this coda may well be found in the 80-proof distillation of postmodern praxis:

> [V]ictory … was not merely about winning a game. It was symbolic, almost like writing a complex narrative where the writer is both the creator and the subject, both the student and the teacher. The recognition of oneself in others and of others in oneself, the awareness of the blurred lines between truth and construction, mirrors the poststructuralist idea that meaning is never fixed but constantly shifting and undergoing contingency, depending on perspective and interpretation.

The narrative episode functions as a parable of *declared engagement*: in the bar-room variant "Call your Play, Call your English," every shot *must* be described in advance, including its spin. This act of fore-naming parallels the ethical and linguistic declaration demanded in self-aware writing—the open acknowledgment of method, motive, and direction. As the match unfolds between novice and local master, the calling of English transforms the game from chance into a dialogue of precision and prediction, a cooperative contest where each participant's stated intention reshapes the other's strategy through transparency. The scientific method projected to the baize.

Through this frame, the coda establishes an analogy among three domains: cue-ball physics, narrative composition, and mathematical formalism. The player's manipulation of spin corresponds to the author's control of meaning and to the mathematician's application of functors and morphisms across categories. Each requires balance between structure and improvisation, between rule and creative deviation. The shared axiom is beauty through constraint—Marston Morse's dictum that from infinity one draws a single pattern "for beauty's sake and pulls it down to earth."

By aligning the embodied learning of the pool table with the abstractions of category theory and adaptive grammar, the section illustrates that mastery in any system—whether physical, linguistic, or mathematical—arises from conscious participation within its rules rather than resistance to them. The "called English" becomes the emblem of reflexive authorship: an explicit engagement with uncertainty that converts play into praxis. In this way, this coda grounds the novel's philosophical investigations in lived experience and prepares the conceptual transition to the purely theoretical reflection that follows in "A Poststructuralist Postscript."

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Coda II — A Poststructuralist Postscript (Précis)

"There is no branch of mathematics, however abstract,
which may not someday be applied to phenomena of the real world."

—Nikolai Ivanovich Lobachevsky

Appearing as the terminal theoretical appendix of *Midnight at the Arcanum: a monograph*, "A Poststructuralist Postscript" completes the monograph's formal architecture review that begins with "Call your Play; Call your English." What follows, as an appendix to the *oeuvre*, is Jackson's play, which he notes, was translated from French to English and was the genesis of the novel's precursor, *Janus Incubus*.[4] Where the first meta-mathematical coda formalizes a category-theoretic model of meaning through engagement, the second situates that model within a poststructuralist and linguistic-philosophical continuum.

Drawing upon the shared logics of category theory and poststructuralist inquiry, the section explores how forgetful and free functors, morphisms, and local mappings correspond to theta-role and X-bar frameworks in linguistics. Both mathematics and poststructuralism, it argues, are systems that transform rather than fix meaning—each privileging context, transformation, and relationality over essential form.

The example *Drain well* demonstrates how even minimal utterances resist singular interpretation; meaning emerges only through local projection, as a manifold appears Euclidean when locally viewed. This linguistic indeterminacy mirrors Wittgenstein's assertion that language both reveals and limits the world, while his later emphasis on showing rather than saying anticipates poststructuralism's embrace of différance and trace.

Within *Midnight at the Arcanum*, the postscript reframes the act of authorship itself as a categorical mapping between lived experience and narrative codomain. Earlier works—including *The Succubus Sea*, *Abadoun*, and *Janus Incubus*—are examined as prior morphisms whose transformations yield the present novel. The variance between autobiography and meta-autobiography is not error but deliberate projectional residue, evidencing the creative tension between authorial intention and reader interpretation.

By aligning formal mathematical structure with the open semantics of poststructuralist reading, the coda positions the reader as the final adjunction in the system: the necessary oracle who collapses potential meaning into comprehension. In doing so, this second coda closes the monograph not with resolution but with recursion, asserting that language, art, and mathematics share a single axiom—meaning is never given, only generated by relation.

[4] In poststructuralism, *no* good read goes unpunished.

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On the Author's Having the Outright *Audacity*…

"*They* say? Who is this *they*, boy? If *you* said it: *sign it*.
If *they* said it, cite them by *name*."—Ronald James Kolosky

While "After Midnight" may at times feel overly familiar, a lexical scan will show that my first use of the first person finds itself on the bottom of Page 6:

> In my own case, because of a lifelong relationship with food scarcity, I have chosen to care by pledging all proceeds from the *Epiphanies Trilogy* to the Greater Vancouver Food Bank, an organization (or one very much like others) that has, over many years and in different ways, literally gotten me this far alive. This journey produced this paper, thus completing the loop. And anyone who has read my short stories knows, I thrive on stories that end where they began—after having (an author hopes, at the very least) reached a valuable conclusion. Understanding becomes care when we engage in dialogue and inform our future from our synthesis.

The first person then carries to the poem on Page 7 and then does not return until this very page.

Which to say, I herein have the audacity to address my peers frankly and openly and with unbridled enthusiasm on the "After Midnight" results because I came down the road to this moment honestly. I read both Tolkien in the complete and *When Worlds Collide* and taught myself what I could of physics from my brother's higher-grade texts while running around feral in the logging camps of Western Canada at an absurdly young age, and sat and listened to my stoic, hard-drinking, lesson-teaching stepfather, Ron, as he trained my mind on Emerson, Lovelace, probability, statistics, and the many variants of poker.

Always the skeptic, my stepfather, Ronald James Kolosky, "Colossal K, the Clocker" was a former tugboat hand and eventual lumberjack, self-educated between shifts, and it was from him that I learned to verify sources, question authority, and try to figure out the odds before putting down a wager, whether it be on a poker hand, or a race horse, or some risk I was about to attempt in life, as he warned me sternly about Ada Lovelace, daughter of Byron the poet, herself having a keen mathematical mind, and who paid a dear price for the fact that in the real world, the money does not always (or even often) follow reason. And it wasn't just Ron—my young world was awash with teachers, mentors, and wiser-maybe friends who pulled me out of a life that was headed down a path of natural and consequential juvenile delinquency. This path is related sufficiently in the first pages of *Midnight at the Arcanum* to not warrant further treatment here, except to note that there also came with those foundational pedagogues a number of lessons and attempts to hammer my round skull into long-entrenched square holes. If I had believed Ms. D. in grade 6 that there was no such thing as the square root of a negative number and left it at that, I imagine I wouldn't be here now, writing this as complexly as I have. Or, as Ron said to me hundreds of times in my youth: you can please some of the people, some of the time, and may even please most of the people, most of the time, but you can't expect to please all the people, all the time. He made it also very clear that it was never about only pleasing oneself: as a union man, he believed in collective responsibility.

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I wanted desperately to go from high school to university so that I could take my accidental lifelong gift for language through the Rigor of the Academy, but I also wanted to not die from starvation. The traditional framework of undergraduate learning, as had the frameworks I'd navigated before that, however, did not answer to *my* ambition, probably because it had no established pedagogic frameworks to do so, no matter how much individual pedagogues in the system may have wished it so.

I had no expectation that it *should* accommodate me, so I walked another path to get here, and found my mentors over the years thanks to the emergent technologies that were suddenly arriving at my doorstep. Modems, FidoNet, Internet, email, queries to world scholars who were quite generous with sending me preprints in a time these things were not as streamlined as they are today.

Years of correspondence with the international body of scholars later, I worked my way from pumping gas, pounding at an Olivetti typewriter as I tried to figure out my craft, to editing others' works instead of focusing solely on my own, to coding math equation parsers and adaptive pattern matchers however the technologies and tools afforded.

I never asked for permission to learn how to live, as it was a matter of emotional, intellectual, and eventually fiscal survival in what otherwise might have been a wasteland. As near as I could determine, the limits I had encountered along the way were structural, rather than hegemonic. This to say, every other author in Canada *also* needed to eat, and in Canada, this meant answering to the Canada Council funding structures, and my time as a literary agent taught me that editors of even some of the most well-established small presses simply could not admit counterexamples. I did not want to write on Canadian topics in my early days, I had even taught myself to type using American spelling for economic reasons, in the days when changing spelling paradigms was not a simple matter best left to the machine. So, as Mr. Shanks, my grade 10 English teacher put it, I had best either learn to write books about finding a "warm place to shit" or I had better consider the US market my only hope. This same pragmatism had to follow me into my career as a software researcher, although I was fortunate to always have a skillset that was, during the impending turn of the Millenium, in high enough demand that I could mostly stay with firms whose efforts best suited my interests while I pursued my deepest computational and mathematical passions on my own time over the Internet at home.

That was an era of emergent intellectual globalization that was hugely democratized. I say *hugely*, rather than *ubiquitously*, because the skillset required to log on and interface with the world of scholars, researchers, and radical vanguard was not universal, nor was the necessary equipment, bandwidth, and other infrastructure. I was a white, articulate, tech-savvy male, and this gave me a small voice in those fora I managed to inhabit. There many, many others who tried and collapsed under circumstances that did not favor their own barriers, and I witnessed these tragedies firsthand in email lists, electronic bulletin board settings, and such, and even came close to self-immolation myself in same.

We sometimes half-joked that the likes of us needed a "survival guide" of sorts as we made our common way along our uncommon path to enlightenment. Some tried, some succeeded in their own estimation, and some folded in on themselves. A few died working work-a-day jobs as they expanded their minds in these places, at least one being murdered. This era, and in these fora, was my training ground proper. Not the university of Hard Knocks, but the colloquium of my peers.

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My fiction, my mathematics, my poetry, my existential despair, all had their testing grounds in a room I knocked to get in so that there would be a better chance for the Grady Towers[5] of the future.

It is no surprise, then, that the core of the original source corpus now found in *Midnight at the Arcanum* comes from work originally put forward in those early fora. These are the same places that presented my mathematics, computational linguistics, and socio-critical essays. As my career progressed, the venues in which I sought publication expanded. Not because I felt a need to be seen, but because, as a scientist and mathematician, I had to reflect and grow professionally, and this expansion meant stepping into other places and holding myself accountable to different and growing expectations.

Eventually, I came to the door of the Science Council UK's Chartered Scientist initiative and ran the gauntlet. I have long admired the UK's tradition of professional validation by peer review and praxis rather than by pedigree alone. It is a system that, at its best, recognizes not just what a person has studied, but what that person has *done*—what they have *made of* their learning in the world.

For someone whose education had been a matter of survival and curiosity rather than syllabus, that framework finally offered something resembling parity: an acknowledgment that rigor, reflection, and contribution can arise through non-traditional pathways as surely as through the academy's corridors. To achieve that standing felt less like joining a club than like closing a circuit. It joined the autodidact's nights of modem static and long correspondence with the international scholarly community to the modern, accredited sphere of professional science. It affirmed that the same discipline that once typed essays by candlelight on an Olivetti could, through perseverance and adaptation, stand shoulder to shoulder with formally trained peers. And I will be frank: the fact that the framework requires yearly revalidation through documented proof of continued progress absolutely sealed the deal for me.

And if it were just about "me" the story would end there. Having come to this point in my career and having been honored with election to Fellowship in the Institute of Science and Technology, I asked myself what I may do to serve those in my various professional circles. My career in mathematics ranges from cancer treatment research via bioinformatic and mathematical analysis, as well as analysis of explainable mathematical models. As much as the exuberant pride in my colleagues and our shared work would love to holler these things out loud from mountaintops, there are matters of non-disclosure that limit me there. I can, however, share what *I* own: and I own my story, and I own its sometimes-hard-won lessons, and I own its scars and sometimes epiphanies. I can offer a hand to any beleaguered soul, who may be, as I sometimes was, one cup of Ramen noodles from collapse, and not just *say* that there is hope, not just *say* "I did it so *you* can, too, champ!" Such "*self*-made" pundits oft forget to cite *their* pedagogues and supports, I've found.

So rather than cajole, I can maybe relate to them *how* "I" did it (but again, not just *me*). Not by relating the specifics in some chronological order, as we see here in these endnotes of gratitude, for that is my specific instantiation, but rather, by writing three *romance* novels (of all things!) wrapped in pedagogic paraphernalia I may never have the skill or enthusiasm to again produce or procure.

[5] In Memoriam Grady Towers: "Grady Towers, one of the most influential members of the higher-IQ-societies community, was murdered on March 20, 2000, at the age of 55, while investigating a break-in at a park facility where he worked as a security guard."

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If my odd path has shown me anything, it is that *self-emancipating self-authorship requires a pedagogy*; I did not arrive at producing this opus on my own. I had to be carried (often sometimes quite literally kicking and screaming), supported, lessoned, and buttressed by myriad mentors, tutors, advisors, readers, colleagues, and friends.

The current pedagogy strives to do *their* effort justice. I can use what I learned over the years to make sure it does not get repackaged and repurposed. I can put it up into the cross-indexed scholarly archive after it has been registered formally in the National Library of Canada, ready for examination and consideration, and I can propose that it is, in fact, a machine for turning enlightenment into *more* cups of Ramen noodles, for other people's hunger. And maybe I can even be playful and suggest, as shown by the fact that Knight Terra Press has been around since 1995, just *before* I formally began my career in computer science, that this is exactly what I set out to do all those many years ago, and thus complete a Möbius circuit I promised to some friends that I might, back in the day.

Wouldn't that be something, don't you think? I think it's just bloody good cricket.

Namaste,

Quinn Tyler Jackson **CSci FIScT SMACM SMIEE FRSA #ActuallyAutistic**
—31 October 2025 (Hallowe'en, the only day this autistic enjoys wearing a mask, *q.v. Touched by Fortune's Shadow*, pp. 249-251)

- [Listen to "Odysseus Canuck," because Canada is where I have loved, spelling or not.]
- [Listen to "Montreal Summer 1990," the theme song to "After Midnight."]

About the Author

Quinn Tyler Jackson CSci FIScT FRSA has been a silkscreen printer's apprentice, a bookseller's assistant, a gas pumpist, a freelance editor, a literary agent, a researcher, a Chief Architect, and is currently a Chief Scientist (Mathematics). Jackson is a Fellow of the Royal Society of Arts, a Chartered Scientist, a Fellow of the Institute of Science & Technology (UK), a Senior Member of both the Association for Computing Machinery, and the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers, and a Member of the London Mathematical Society, the American Mathematical Society, and the Writers' Union of Canada. His award-winning publication history spans three decades, and he has had three novels published in the UK and has had short stories and poetry published in various littles and online journals.

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[6] 勇 知 默 Courage, Wisdom, Silence; *Audere*, *Scire, Tacere*.

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